ShipWright Hack Day Guide

Oct 10, 2026 · @Anurag singh

Every pull request you open during Hacktoberfest Hack Day Bengaluru (build phase 10–18 October 2026) can get a free AI code review from ShipWright, the event's Code Review Partner. Setup takes about five minutes, and no payment details are needed.

ShipWright reads your changes and replies on the PR within a few minutes. You get a plain-English summary of what changed, comments on the exact lines that need attention with a suggested fix for each, and a verdict check. It never pushes, merges or deploys anything.

The whole flow in six steps:

1. Create a public GitHub repo for your project.
2. Install the ShipWright app on that repo.
3. Work on a branch and open a pull request.
4. Read ShipWright's review.
5. Fix what's valid, push, then merge.
6. Submit your repo URL to KrowdKraft.

Before you start

You need three things:

- **A GitHub account** for each team member who will push code.
- **Git on your laptop**, or GitHub Desktop if you prefer a visual tool. You'll create branches and push them.
- **Admin access to the repo** for whoever installs ShipWright. Usually that's the person who creates the repo.

Step 1: Create a public repo

One repo per team, and it must be **public**: PRs in private repos still get reviewed, but they don't count on the event leaderboard.

1. Go to github.com/new.
2. Name it after your project and choose **Public**.
3. Tick **Add a README file**, so the repo has a `main` branch to open PRs against.
4. Click **Create repository**, then add your teammates under **Settings → Collaborators**.

Already have a repo? Make sure it's public and skip to Step 2.

Step 2: Install ShipWright on your repo

1. Open github.com/apps/shipwright-agent and click **Install**.
2. Pick the account or organisation that owns your project repo.
3. Choose **Only select repositories** and select your project repo.
4. Click **Install**.

Within a minute, a new issue titled along the lines of "ShipWright is set up" appears in your repo. That's your confirmation that the install worked, and it lists the commands you can use. You can close it once you've read it.

Choose **Only select repositories** rather than **All repositories**. With "All", ShipWright still reviews your PRs, but no welcome issue is created, so you can't tell at a glance that it's working.

Only one person per team needs to install it. Everyone who opens a PR in that repo gets reviews.

Step 3: Open a pull request

ShipWright reviews **pull requests**, not plain pushes. Anything pushed straight to `main` is never reviewed, so build each feature on its own branch.

In a terminal:

```
git checkout -b add-login-page
# write your code
git add .
git commit -m "Add login page"
git push -u origin add-login-page
```

Then on GitHub, click **Compare & pull request** and open the PR into `main`.

With GitHub Desktop: **Branch → New branch**, commit your changes, click **Publish branch**, then **Create Pull Request**.

Three things to keep in mind:

- **Branch inside your own repo.** PRs from a fork only get ShipWright's basic automated checks, not the full AI review. Teammates should be added as collaborators and push branches to the team repo.
- **Drafts are skipped.** A draft PR isn't reviewed until you click **Ready for review**, or comment `/shipwright verify` on it.

- **Keep PRs small.** One feature or fix per PR gets the sharpest review. PRs with more than 5,000 changed lines are skipped.

Step 4: Read the review

A few minutes after you open the PR, ShipWright adds four things:

Where	What you see
PR description	A **Summary by ShipWright**: what the PR changes, its type and its merge risk
Conversation tab	One **review comment** with the verdict, a walkthrough of the changes by file, and the number of actionable comments
Files changed tab	**Inline comments** on specific lines, each with a severity, the impact, a suggested fix and a ready-made prompt for your AI coding tool
Checks	A **Shipwright / release-recommendation** check showing the verdict

The verdict tells you what to do next:

Verdict	Check	What to do
✅ Approve	success	Ready to merge
⚠️ Approve with conditions	neutral	Read the notes, then merge. A neutral check never blocks merging.
❌ Changes requested	failure	Fix the flagged problems first
⛔ Blocked	failure	Serious risk found. Don't merge until it's fixed.

PRs that change dependency files (`package.json` , `requirements.txt` and similar), touch auth or payment code, or run past 800 lines are marked high risk. They usually show ⚠️ with the note "human approval required". That only means a teammate should look at the PR before merging; you don't need to do anything else.

ShipWright can be wrong. If a comment doesn't apply, ignore it or reply to say why.

Step 5: Fix, push, merge

1. Fix the comments that are valid. Each inline comment has a prompt you can paste into Copilot, Cursor or Claude to make the fix.
2. Commit and push to the **same branch**. ShipWright reviews the new commit automatically and updates its review comment.
3. The review comment then shows ✅ **N comments fixed since the last review** for every issue you resolved.
4. When you're happy with the verdict, click **Merge pull request**.

Then start the next feature on a new branch and repeat from Step 3. A steady flow of small, reviewed and merged PRs is what counts on the leaderboard.

Step 6: Submit and track your progress

When you submit your project to KrowdKraft, include your **public repo URL** in the submission form.

The live leaderboard is at shipwright-agent.onrender.com/leaderboard, and it will be on screen at the venue on 18 October. A PR counts once it is all of these:

- in a public repo with ShipWright installed
- opened on or after 10 October 2026
- reviewed by ShipWright
- merged
- opened by a person, not a bot

Teams are ranked first by PRs where you **pushed a fix after the review**, then by total counted PRs. Reviews you act on rank higher than reviews you only read.

Best use of ShipWright track: judged on the event day. Judging criteria and the prize will be announced by KrowdKraft.

Fair play

The leaderboard rewards real work, so:

- **Real changes only.** Empty PRs, whitespace-only PRs or one-line PRs opened just to raise your count may be removed from the leaderboard.
- **Up to 100 reviewed PRs per repo.** Beyond that, new PRs aren't reviewed. PRs already reviewed are still re-reviewed when you push.
- **No bots.** PRs opened by bots, such as Dependabot, don't count.

- **Your code stays yours.** ShipWright only reads the repos you install it on, and its comments are suggestions. You decide what to merge.
- The event follows the MLH Code of Conduct.

Troubleshooting

Problem	Likely cause	Fix
No welcome issue after installing	You picked **All repositories**, or Issues are turned off in the repo	Nothing is broken. Open a PR to check that reviews arrive.
No review after 10 minutes	ShipWright isn't installed on this repo, or the PR is a draft	Check **Settings → GitHub Apps** in the repo. For a draft, click **Ready for review**.
No review on a PR	You pushed straight to `main`	Only PRs are reviewed. Use a branch for the next change.
Only basic checks, no inline comments	The PR comes from a fork	Push the branch to the team repo and open the PR from there.
Check says "skipped: pull request limit reached"	The repo has had 100 PRs reviewed	Already-reviewed PRs still get re-reviewed. Make each new PR count.
Check says "skipped: hosted quota limit"	Too many reviews running for your account at once	Wait a few minutes, then comment `/shipwright rerun`.
Check says "skipped" on a huge PR	More than 5,000 changed lines	Split it into smaller PRs.
Review looks stale or failed	A temporary error	Comment `/shipwright rerun`, or click **Re-run** on the check in the Checks tab.

PR commands (post them as a comment on the PR):

Command	What it does
`/shipwright rerun`	Reviews the latest commit again
`/shipwright verify`	Reviews a draft PR

Quick links and help

What	Link
Install ShipWright	github.com/apps/shipwright-agent
Live leaderboard	shipwright-agent.onrender.com/leaderboard
Event page	Hacktoberfest Hack Day Bengaluru on MLH

Stuck? Post in the event WhatsApp or Discord group with your repo URL and the PR number, and the ShipWright team will help.